

1. Game Title

Mystery Mansion Adventure

2. Genre

Interactive Mystery / Detective Adventure (Text-Based)

3. Narrative Overview

Mystery Mansion Adventure is a narrative-driven detective game set within Ravenwood Mansion, a grand and isolated estate owned by a wealthy family. During a formal evening gathering, the family's heir, **Arthur Ravenwood**, mysteriously disappears. All exits are sealed, and no one is allowed to leave until the truth is uncovered.

Over the course of four nights, the player investigates Arthur's disappearance by exploring rooms, speaking with characters, and unlocking areas using **usable key items**. As the investigation progresses, it becomes clear that Arthur did not simply vanish—he was murdered and deliberately hidden in the mansion's basement. By connecting evidence gathered across multiple nights, the player must deduce that Arthur's **eldest son, Lucian Ravenwood**, is the true culprit.

4. Setting

The entire game takes place inside **Ravenwood Mansion**, which becomes fully locked once Arthur is reported missing. The confined setting heightens tension and ensures that the murderer must be among those inside.

Mansion Rooms

- Main Hall
- Living Room
- Dining Room
- Kitchen
- Library
- Arthur's Bedroom
- Garden
- Basement
- Hidden Basement Room (unlocked only on Night 4)

Room access is strictly controlled by **night progression**.

5. Core Design Rules

- The story unfolds over **four nights**
- New rooms unlock each night
- **Key items are usable objects only** (keys, tools)
- **Clues are not key items**
- Clues appear only after rooms or containers are unlocked
- Accusations are allowed **only on Night 4**

6. Characters & Suspects (NPCS)

Arthur Ravenwood (Victim)

- Heir to Ravenwood Mansion
 - Involved in inheritance disputes
 - Planned to disinherit his eldest son
 - Murdered by blunt force trauma and hidden in the basement
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Family Members

Lucian Ravenwood - Eldest Son (True Culprit)

Public Image: Calm, cooperative, rational

Actual Motive:

Arthur planned to remove Lucian entirely from the will, stripping him of inheritance and status. Lucian confronted Arthur privately, killed him in a moment of rage, and hid the body in a concealed basement room while redirecting suspicion toward others.

Charles Ravenwood - Arthur's Brother (Primary Feint)

Suspicion Level: High

Reasons:

- Heavy gambling debts
- Public inheritance argument
- Seen using a knife the day before

Arthur's Wife

Suspicion Level: Medium

Reasons:

- Financial dependence
- Strained marriage

Eliza Ravenwood - Arthur's Daughter

Suspicion Level: Minor

Reasons:

- Aware of family secrets
 - Quiet and withdrawn
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Mansion Staff

Edmund - Head Butler

Suspicion Level: Medium

Reasons:

- Access to restricted areas
- Controls keys and movement

Thomas - Groundskeeper

Suspicion Level: Medium

Reasons:

- Garden and basement access
- Financial desperation

Clara - Housekeeper

Suspicion Level: Minor

Reasons:

- Resentment toward Arthur
- Access to private rooms

7. NPC Placement by Room

Room	NPCs
Main Hall	Head Butler, Arthur's Wife
Living Room	Lucian, Charles
Dining Room	None
Kitchen	Housekeeper
Library	Eliza
Arthur's Bedroom	None
Garden	Groundskeeper
Basement	None

8. Night-by-Night Progression

Night 1

Available Rooms: Main Hall, Living Room, Dining Room, Kitchen

Key Item

- **Kitchen Storage Key** (from Housekeeper)
 - Unlocks kitchen cabinet

Clues Unlocked

- **Kitchen Knife** (*Feint*) — implicates Charles
- **Inheritance Argument** (*Dialogue*) — Living Room
- **Broken Wine Glass** (*Feint*) — Dining Room
- **Locked Mansion Confirmation** (*Dialogue*) — Main Hall

Narrative Purpose:

Establish a locked-in scenario and push strong early suspicion toward Charles.

Night 2

New Rooms: Library, Arthur's Bedroom

Key Items

- **Library Access Permission** (from Arthur's Wife)
- **Arthur's Bedroom Key** (from Lucian)

Clues Unlocked

- **Altered Will Draft** (*True*) — Lucian removed as heir
- **Gambling Ledger** (*Feint*) — Charles' debts
- **Arthur's Journal** (*True*) — Arthur feared Lucian's reaction
- **Arthur's Wife's Letter** (*Feint*) — financial anxiety

Narrative Purpose:

Introduce Lucian's motive subtly while maintaining Charles as the main suspect.

Night 3

New Rooms: Garden, Basement

Key Items

- **Garden Door Key** (from Head Butler)
- **Garden Shed Key** (from Groundskeeper)
- **Basement Stair Key** (from Head Butler)

Clues Unlocked

- **Groundskeeper's Tools** (*Feint*) — shovel and crowbar
- **Footprints Near Basement Window** (*True*) — movement toward basement
- **Blood-Stained Paperweight** (*True*) — blunt murder weapon
- **Basement Drag Marks** (*True*) — body moved and hidden

Narrative Purpose:

Reveal how Arthur was killed and confirm deliberate concealment, while keeping multiple suspects plausible.

Night 4

New Area: Hidden Basement Room

Key Item

- **Hammer** (from Groundskeeper)
 - Used to break the old latch mechanism

Clues Unlocked

- **Arthur's Body** (*True*)
 - Cause of death: blunt force trauma
 - Time of death: shortly after dinner
- **No Defensive Wounds** (*True*)
 - Arthur showed no signs of resistance
 - Indicates he trusted his attacker
- **Housekeeper's Testimony** (*True*)
 - Overheard a heated argument between Arthur and Lucian
- **Lucian's Timeline Contradiction** (*True*)
 - His alibi conflicts with the Butler and Arthur's wife

Narrative Purpose:

Collapse all false leads and reveal Lucian as the only suspect who fits motive, opportunity, action, and deception.

9. Deduction Logic

To correctly accuse Lucian, the player must connect:

- **Motive:** Altered will, Arthur's journal
- **Opportunity:** Family access, basement movement
- **Action:** Blunt weapon, drag marks
- **Trust:** No defensive wounds
- **Deception:** Contradictory alibi

No other suspect satisfies all conditions.

10. Accusation System

On Night 4, the player must:

1. Present multiple connected clues
2. Explain motive, opportunity, and action
3. Justify why other suspects are false leads

Incorrect accusations result in failure.

11. Endings

Successful Ending

Lucian Ravenwood is exposed as Arthur's murderer, and justice is served.

Failure Endings

- Wrong suspect accused
- Insufficient evidence presented

In both cases, the truth remains hidden.

12. Themes & Learning Objectives

- Logical deduction over assumptions
- Manipulation and misdirection
- Cause-and-effect reasoning
- Evidence-based conclusions

13. Summary

Mystery Mansion Adventure is a structured, multi-night murder mystery in which players unlock areas using usable items, analyze interconnected clues, reject convincing false leads, and logically identify the true murderer behind Arthur Ravenwood's death.